

Build dashboards people can actually use.

Today we turn yesterday's charts into an interactive report using Google Sheets and Looker Studio through the Data Studio reporting link.

Looker Studio

Data Studio link

Google Sheets connector

Filters

Dashboard project

Final output

A simple interactive dashboard with KPIs, charts, filters, insight text, and safe sharing settings.

Day 15: charts

1. Clean data.
2. Choose chart types.
3. Build charts in Google Sheets.
4. Use AI to explain patterns.
5. Write insight titles.

Day 16: dashboards

1. Connect Sheets to Looker Studio.
2. Create KPIs, charts, and controls.
3. Design a dashboard layout.
4. Use AI to audit clarity.
5. Share safely with viewers.

● ● ● WHAT IS A DASHBOARD?

Monitor

Shows current status: sales today, attendance this week, tickets open, campaign spend.

Diagnose

Helps users find what changed and where: by region, channel, product, date, or team.

Decide

Supports an action: continue, stop, investigate, allocate budget, contact someone, improve process.

Dashboard rule: If the viewer does not know what to do next, the dashboard is not finished.

Use Google Sheets as the data source and Looker Studio as the dashboard layer.

1

Sheet

Clean one table.

2

Open

Data Studio reporting link.

3

Connect

Add Google Sheets data.

4

Model

Check fields and types.

5

Build

Add KPIs and charts.

6

Control

Add filters and date range.

7

Share

Review access and publish.

Dimensions

Dimensions describe the record. They are usually categories, dates, names, locations, products, channels, or statuses.

Date

Channel

Region

Product

Metrics

Metrics are numbers that can be counted, summed, averaged, or compared.

Leads

Sales

Revenue

Rating

● ● ● COMMON DASHBOARD TYPES

Executive summary

Few KPIs, key trend, top risks, and next actions. Best for leaders.

Operations tracker

Daily or weekly status, filters, tables, and exceptions. Best for teams.

Marketing dashboard

Channels, spend, leads, conversion, campaign performance, and revenue.

Student or class dashboard

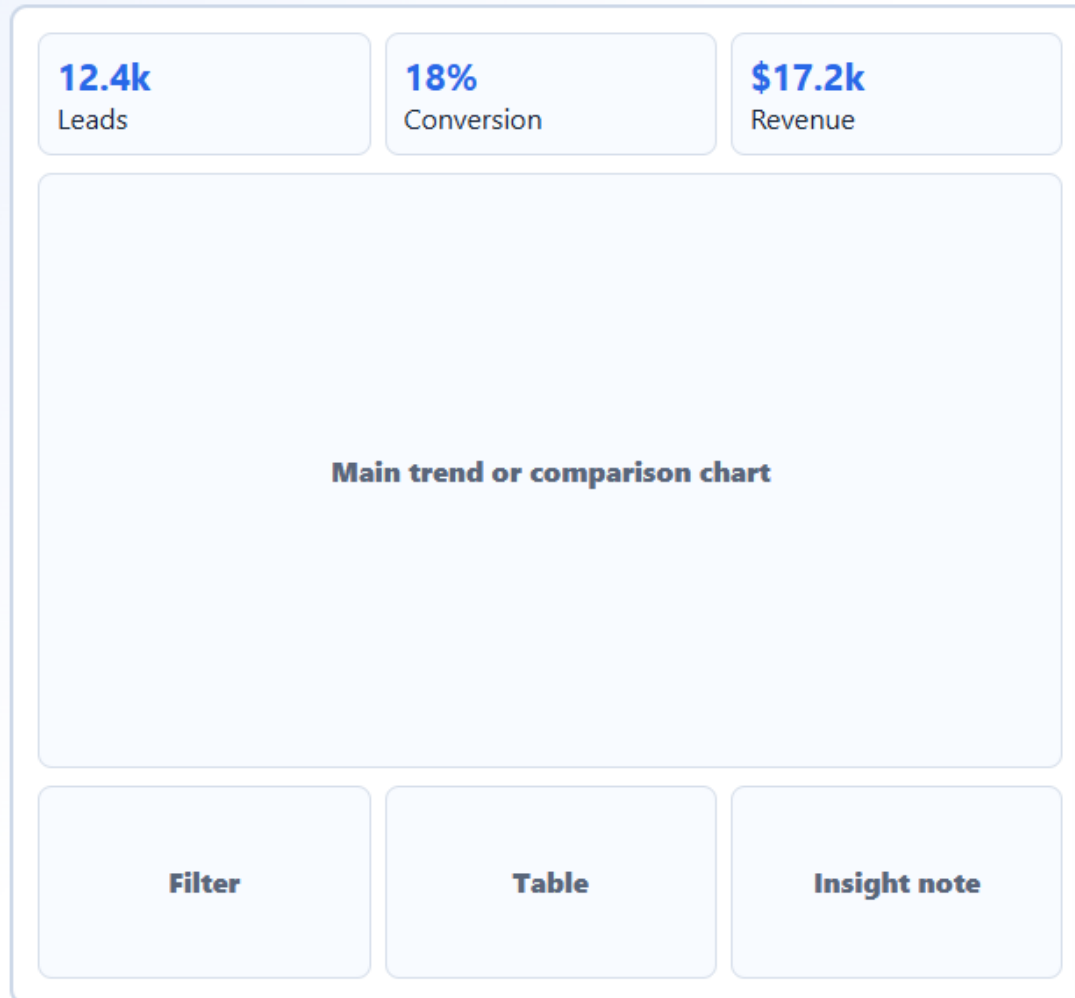
Attendance, assignments, progress, support needs, and improvements over time.

Finance dashboard

Revenue, expenses, budget variance, cash flow, and categories needing review.

Project dashboard

Milestones, tasks, delays, blockers, owners, and risk status.



Design for scanning from top-left to bottom-right

Place content by importance

1. Top: dashboard title, date range, filters.
2. First row: most important KPIs.
3. Middle: main trend and comparison charts.
4. Bottom: detail table and notes.
5. Side or top: controls users need often.

● ● ● AI PROMPT | DASHBOARD PLANNING BRIEF

COPY-READY PLANNING PROMPT Act as a dashboard designer and beginner-friendly data analyst.

I want to build a Looker Studio dashboard from a Google Sheets table.

Audience:
[WHO WILL USE THE DASHBOARD]

Decision or purpose:
[WHAT THEY NEED TO MONITOR OR DECIDE]

Columns:
[PASTE COLUMN NAMES]

Available charts from Day 15:
[PASTE CHARTS OR INSIGHTS]

Create a dashboard plan with:

1. Dashboard title.
2. 3-5 KPI scorecards.
3. 4-6 charts with chart type, dimension, metric, and purpose.
4. Filters or controls users need.
5. Suggested layout from top to bottom.
6. Insight text boxes to include.
7. Data quality checks before publishing.

Keep the plan possible in Looker Studio using Google Sheets as the data source. Do not invent values.

Use before opening the tool

1. Decide audience.
2. Paste columns.
3. Paste Day 15 insights.
4. Approve the plan.
5. Build only what supports the decision.

Copy planning prompt

Steps

1. Open <https://datastudio.google.com/navigation/reporting>
2. Create a blank report.
3. Choose Google Sheets as data source.
4. Select the Day 15 spreadsheet and worksheet.
5. Confirm first row contains headers.
6. Add the data to the report.
7. Check field names and data types.

First checks

1. Date should be Date.
2. Revenue, Sales, and Leads should be numeric.
3. Channel, Region, and Product should be text.
4. Rating should be numeric or decimal.
5. No blank header names.

Time: 20 minutes

 BUILD THE KPI ROW

Total Leads

Scorecard using SUM of Leads. Shows demand or interest.

Total Sales

Scorecard using SUM of Sales. Shows completed outcomes.

Total Revenue

Scorecard using SUM of Revenue. Format as currency if appropriate.

Conversion Rate

Calculated field: Sales / Leads. Format as percent.

Average Rating

Scorecard using AVG of Rating. Useful for quality signal.

Date Range

Control that lets viewers change the reporting period.

CALCULATED FIELDS WITH AI HELP

CALCULATED FIELD PROMPT I am building a Looker Studio dashboard from Google Sheets.

Fields:
[PASTE FIELD NAMES AND TYPES]

I need calculated fields for:
[EXAMPLE: conversion rate, revenue per sale, lead quality segment]

Write beginner-friendly Looker Studio calculated field formulas.
For each formula, explain:

- Field name
- Formula
- Data type or format
- What it means
- What to check if it returns errors

Do not assume fields exist unless I listed them.

Example formulas

Conversion Rate	Sales / Leads
Revenue per Sale	Revenue / Sales
High Rating Flag	CASE WHEN Rating >= 4.5 THEN "High" ELSE "Normal" END

Copy formula prompt

● ● ● DASHBOARD CHART SET

Dashboard question	Chart	Dimension	Metric
Which channel performs best?	Sorted bar chart	Channel	Revenue or Sales
How does performance change over time?	Line chart	Date	Revenue, Leads, or Sales
Which region needs attention?	Bar chart or map if regions are geographic	Region	Conversion Rate
Which product earns more?	Column chart	Product	Revenue
What are the exact details?	Table	Date, Channel, Product	Leads, Sales, Revenue

Use Day 15 chart rules inside Day 16 dashboards

● ● ● **ADD INTERACTIVITY WITH CONTROLS**

Date range control

Lets viewers choose the reporting period. Use when data includes dates.

Drop-down filter

Best for Channel, Region, Product, Team, Class, or Status.

Search box

Useful when there are many names, products, or locations.

Chart interaction

Let viewers click a chart to filter the report if the interaction is clear.

Page filter

Useful when one dashboard has pages for summary, details, and exceptions.

Reset habit

Teach viewers how to clear filters so they do not misread partial views.

Use text to guide attention

1. State the most important finding.
2. Name the metric and time period.
3. Mention a likely limitation.
4. Suggest what to check next.
5. Keep it short enough to scan.

DASHBOARD INSIGHT PROMPT Here are my dashboard charts and summary values:

[PASTE CHART TITLES + KEY NUMBERS]

Write 3 short dashboard insight notes for [AUDIENCE].

Each note should:

- Start with the main finding.
- Mention the supporting metric.
- Avoid claiming a cause unless proven.
- Suggest one follow-up action.
- Use plain language.

Keep each note under 25 words.

 DASHBOARD DESIGN CHECKLIST

Readable

Can a viewer read titles, labels, and numbers without zooming?

Consistent

Are colors, date ranges, metric names, and number formats consistent?

Focused

Does each chart support the main decision?

Interactive

Do filters change the expected charts?

Verified

Do dashboard totals match Google Sheets totals?

Safe

Are sharing permissions appropriate for the data?

● ● ● AI PROMPT | DASHBOARD AUDIT

COPY-READY AUDIT PROMPT Act as a dashboard reviewer.

Dashboard purpose:
[PURPOSE]

Audience:
[AUDIENCE]

Charts and KPIs:
[LIST DASHBOARD COMPONENTS]

Filters:
[LIST FILTERS]

Key insights:
[PASTE INSIGHT TEXT]

Audit the dashboard for:

1. Clarity of purpose.
2. Missing KPIs or unnecessary charts.
3. Better chart type choices.
4. Confusing labels or titles.
5. Data quality and formula risks.
6. Privacy or sharing risks.
7. One high-impact improvement I should make first.

Be practical and beginner-friendly.

Use after first draft

1. List what is on the dashboard.
2. Ask for critique.
3. Choose one improvement.
4. Update the dashboard.
5. Verify with a classmate.

Copy audit prompt

Before sharing

1. Remove private rows or sensitive columns.
2. Check report data credentials.
3. Use viewer access unless editing is needed.
4. Test the link in another browser or account.
5. Confirm filters do not reveal hidden sensitive details.

Share options

1. Private report for yourself.
2. Specific people with viewer access.
3. Class/team share link.
4. Embedded report on a site, only for public-safe data.
5. PDF export or screenshot for static reporting.

Never publish sensitive dashboards publicly

Required components

1. Dashboard title and purpose.
2. 3 KPI scorecards.
3. One trend chart.
4. Two comparison charts.
5. One filter control.
6. One detail table.
7. Two short insight notes.

Time: 55 minutes

60-second presentation

1. Who is the dashboard for?
2. What decision does it support?
3. What is the most important KPI?
4. What chart gives the strongest insight?
5. What limitation should viewers remember?

 FACILITATOR VIEW | DAY 16 SCHEDULE

Time	Block	Visible output
00:00-00:20	Dashboard theory and Day 15 recap	Dashboard purpose
00:20-00:45	Open Data Studio/Looker Studio and connect Google Sheets	Connected data source
00:45-01:15	Fields, dimensions, metrics, and calculated fields	KPI definitions
01:15-01:25	Break	Reset
01:25-02:15	Build KPI row, trend chart, and comparison charts	Dashboard draft
02:15-02:45	Add filters, tables, and insight notes	Interactive report
02:45-02:55	Break	Reset
02:55-03:25	AI audit, design cleanup, and data verification	Repaired dashboard
03:25-04:00	Share settings, presentations, and reflection	Final dashboard link or export

Dashboards work when they make the next action clearer.

Audience

Decision

KPIs

Filters

Verification

Safe sharing

Print / Save PDF

Exit ticket

1. What decision does your dashboard support?
2. Which KPI matters most?
3. Which filter is most useful?
4. What did AI help improve?
5. What access setting did you choose?